

Event Offers & Email Notification System Guide

This document explains how to create event offers and send promotional emails to customers using the Restaurant Management System.

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Overview

The Event Offers system allows you to create special promotions, events, or offers for your restaurant and notify customers via email. This is a powerful marketing tool to:

- Announce special events (holiday meals, live music, etc.)
- Promote limited-time offers and discounts
- Inform customers about seasonal menu changes
- Send personalized promotional content

Creating Event Offers

Step 1: Access Event Offers Dashboard

1. Log in to your admin dashboard
2. Navigate to **Dashboard** → **Event Offers**
3. Click the **"Add New Offer"** button

Step 2: Fill in Offer Details

Complete the form with these details:

- **Offer Name:** A clear, attention-grabbing title (e.g., "Weekend Brunch Special")
- **Description:** Detailed information about the offer
- **Offer Type:** Select from preset types (Discount, Special Menu, Event, etc.)
- **Start Date:** When the offer becomes valid
- **End Date:** When the offer expires
- **Image** (optional): Upload an image for the offer
- **Terms & Conditions** (optional): Any restrictions or requirements

Step 3: Save the Offer

Click **"Save Offer"** to create the event offer. It will now appear in your Event Offers list.

Sending Email Notifications

Step 1: Access Email System

1. Navigate to **Dashboard** → **Email**
2. You'll see two tabs:
 - **Event/Offer Emails:** Send notifications about existing event offers
 - **Custom Message:** Create a custom email message

Step 2: Select Recipients

In the right panel:

1. You'll see a list of all customers with email addresses
2. Use the search and filtering options to find specific customers
3. Select recipients by:
 - Checking individual customers
 - Using **"Select All"** to choose everyone
 - Filtering by name and using bulk selection

Step 3: Compose the Email

For Event/Offer Emails:

1. Select the event offer from the dropdown menu
2. Preview the offer details that will be included in the email
3. *Optional:* Test the email by entering your email address in the "Test Before Sending" field and clicking "Test"

For Custom Messages:

1. Enter a subject line
2. Compose your message
3. *Optional:* Test as described above

Step 4: Send the Email

1. Review your selections to confirm:
 - The correct offer or message
 - The right recipients (check count)
2. Click **"Send to X Selected Users"** button
3. Confirm in the popup dialog
4. A progress indicator will show the email sending status

Advanced Features

Filtering Recipients

- Use the **Filters** button to show search and sorting options
- Search by name or email
- Sort alphabetically (A-Z or Z-A)

Testing Emails

Always test emails before sending to customers:

1. Enter a test email address
2. Click "Test"
3. Check your inbox to see exactly how the email will appear to customers

Tracking Results

The system provides basic statistics after sending:

- Total emails attempted
- Successfully delivered
- Failed deliveries

Troubleshooting

Common Issues

No users appear in the list:

- Check that customers have valid email addresses
- Refresh the page to reload user data
- Ensure you have admin privileges

Test emails not arriving:

- Check spam/junk folders
- Verify the test email address is correct
- Contact system administrator if persistent

Emails failing to send:

- Check internet connection
- Ensure email service is properly configured
- Try sending to fewer recipients at once

Best Practices

1. **Timing:** Send promotional emails during business hours (10am-3pm) for best open rates
2. **Frequency:** Limit emails to 1-2 per week to prevent customer fatigue
3. **Targeting:** Select specific customer segments rather than always sending to everyone
4. **Testing:** Always send a test email to yourself first
5. **Content:** Keep messages concise with clear call-to-action

For technical support, please contact your system administrator or IT support team.